

# Justin D. Norman

Berkeley, CA

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## Current Position

**UC Berkeley, School of Information**

*Research Scientist*

Advisors: Michael U. Rivera and D. Alex Hughes

**Berkeley, CA**

*Nov 2025–Present*

## Education

**University of California, Berkeley**

*Ph.D., Information Systems*

*2026*

Concentration: Computer Vision & Machine Learning

Advisor: Hany Farid

**University of Southern California, Marshall School of Business**

*M.B.A.*

*2015*

Concentration: Business Analytics

**University of Southern California**

*M.S. Certificate, Technology Commercialization*

*2015*

**United States Naval Academy**

*B.S., Computer Science*

*2007*

## Research Agenda

My research is focused on computational evaluations of the impact that AI/ML proliferation and normalization have on society. I develop computational methods for deepfake detection and digital forensics, evaluate LLM and VLM robustness through repeatable and expert-grounded benchmarks, and study the ethical implications of AI systems, including how LLM chatbots may influence users' moral reasoning. This work bridges computer science, information science, and the social sciences.

## Publications

**2026:** J.D. Norman. "When 95% Accuracy Isn't Good Enough: Bridging the Gap Between Forensic Biometric Facial Recognition Benchmarks and Real-World Human Impact." In *Proc. IEEE/CVF CVPR, Workshop on Humans of Generative AI (HuG)*, 2026.

**2026:** J.D. Norman, M.U. Rivera, and D.A. Hughes. "Reliability without Validity: A Systematic, Large-Scale Evaluation of LLM-as-a-Judge Models Across Agreement, Consistency, and Bias." *Under review*.

**2026:** J.D. Norman and S. Barrington. "Audio Deepfake Detection Using Temporal Coherence Analysis." *Under review*.

**2026:** J.D. Norman and H. Farid. "Detecting Deepfake Talking Heads from Facial Biometric Anomalies." In *Proc. IEEE/CVF WACV, Workshop on Safe AI for All Domains (SAFE)*, 2026.

**2026:** J.D. Norman, D.A. Hughes, and M.U. Rivera. "The Case for Repeatable, Open, and Expert-Grounded Hallucination Benchmarks in Large Language Models." In *Proc. ICICT*, 2026. Oral presentation.

**2025:** J.D. Norman and H. Farid. "Does Head Pose Correction Improve Biometric Facial Recognition?" *Under review*.

**2025:** J.D. Norman and J. Doering. "Formulation of Personal Ethics in Conversation with Large Language Models." *FASPE Journal*.

**2024:** J.D. Norman and C.D. Whitney. "Real Risks of Fake Data: Synthetic Data, Diversity-Washing and Consent Circumvention." In *Proc. ACM FAccT*, 2024.

**2024:** J.D. Norman and H. Farid. "An Investigation into the Impact of AI-Powered Image Enhancement on Forensic

Biometrics." In *Proc. IEEE/CVF CVPR Workshops*, 2024.

**2023:** J.D. Norman, S. Agarwal, and H. Farid. "An Evaluation of Forensic Facial Recognition." *arXiv:2311.06145*, 2023.

**2021:** J.D. Norman, P. Skomoroch, and M. Loukides. *Product Management for AI*. O'Reilly Media, 2021.

## Select Professional Experience

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| <b>Vera AI</b><br><i>Chief Technology Officer / Head of AI</i><br>Led AI/ML strategy and engineering for content authenticity and deepfake detection platform.                                    | <b>San Francisco, CA</b><br>2022–2025 |
| <b>Defense Innovation Unit, U.S. DoD</b><br><i>AI/ML Portfolio Director (Acting)</i><br>Directed AI/ML investment portfolio; coordinated prototype-to-production transitions across DoD services. | <b>Mountain View, CA</b><br>2023–2024 |
| <b>Yelp</b><br><i>Vice President, Data Science</i><br>Led organization of 50+ data scientists and ML engineers across product, ads, and trust & safety.                                           | <b>San Francisco, CA</b><br>2019–2022 |
| <b>Cloudera Fast Forward Labs</b><br><i>Director, Research &amp; Machine Learning</i><br>Directed applied ML research; published reports on NLP, computer vision, and interpretability.           | <b>San Francisco, CA</b><br>2018–2019 |
| <b>Fitbit</b><br><i>Senior Manager, Applied Machine Learning</i><br>Led ML team for health and fitness product features.                                                                          | <b>San Francisco, CA</b><br>2018      |
| <b>Cisco Systems</b><br><i>Senior Manager, Enterprise Data Science</i><br>Built and managed enterprise data science practice across business units.                                               | <b>San Jose, CA</b><br>2016–2018      |
| <b>Booz Allen Hamilton</b><br><i>Data Scientist</i><br>Applied advanced analytics to national security and defense clients.                                                                       | <b>Washington, DC</b><br>2014–2016    |
| <b>United States Marine Corps</b><br><i>Officer</i><br>Infantry and intelligence assignments; deployed in support of overseas operations.                                                         | <b>Various</b><br>2007–2011           |

## Awards & Fellowships

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**2024:** FASPE Design & Technology Fellowship

**2020:** Marcus Foster Fellowship, UC Berkeley

## Certifications

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**2023:** Project Management Professional (PMP), renewed

**2017:** INFORMS Associate Certified Analytics Professional (aCAP)

## Service

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| <b>Berkeley Public Interest Technology Clinic</b><br><i>Technical Director</i><br>Deploy data science and technology projects for civic impact, including engagements with the U.S. Treasury, Habitat for Humanity, and MLT. | <b>UC Berkeley</b><br>2025–Present                    |
| <b>Digital Security, Safety, and Trust Search Committee</b><br><i>PhD Representative</i><br>Participated in faculty search process for new tenure-track position.                                                            | <b>UC Berkeley School of Information</b><br>2025      |
| <b>INFO 290T: Computer Vision</b><br><i>Graduate Student Instructor</i>                                                                                                                                                      | <b>UC Berkeley School of Information</b><br>Fall 2022 |